

DM-Inc ERP Implementation Plan

The following is Elf's recommended implementation approach for deploying the DM-Inc ERP on AWS. This plan focuses on the implementation of, migration to, and adoption of the operations platform developed by Elf. This implementation plan focuses on environment setup, security, S3-backed document storage enablement, configuration, data migration, training, and controlled systems migration.

6-week indicative programme

Pilot then firm-wide cutover

AWS production deployment

S3-backed document estate

Role-based training and support

INDICATIVE DURATION

6 Weeks

Practical delivery window for a controlled implementation with migration rehearsal, user acceptance testing, training, and structured cutover.

GO-LIVE STAGES

2-stage

Pilot validation with select representatives first, followed by firm-wide launch once migration, finance, and security sign-off are complete.

CLIENT REPRESENTATIVES

8-9 people

Executive sponsor, finance lead, operations lead, IT lead, and a small representative cohort across practice teams.

POST DEPLOYMENT SUPPORT

2 weeks

Dedicated support immediately after go-live for issue triage, workflow tuning, and user support.

Implementation Posture

The ERP platform contains the core legal workflow, finance, portal, analytics, knowledge, helpdesk, and asset-management functionalities needed for DM-Inc's operating model.

The implementation effort therefore concentrates on configuration, migration, security, storage architecture, user readiness, and production transitions.

- AWS as the cloud provider with PostgreSQL in RDS and the DM-Inc document repository

Platform Scope

The implementation plan is aligned to the modules present on the ERP platform.

Dashboard

Matters

Calendar & Docketing

DMS

Timekeeping

Billing

Trust Accounting

CRM & Intake

Client Portal

Knowledge Base

Analytics

Helpdesk

moved to Amazon S3.

- S3-backed document storage as part of implementation before production cutover.
- Rollout schedule such that matter operations, calendar, DMS, and timekeeping are stable.
- Billing, trust accounting, portal, helpdesk, and analytics deployed in controlled waves tied to sign-off.

Asset Registry

Proposed Delivery Phases

1 Blueprint confirmation

Indicative timing: Week 1

Primary objective: Finalise implementation shape, source systems, user groups, reporting priorities, and success criteria.

Key outputs: Agreed scope baseline, delivery calendar, named client owners, security and role matrix draft, migration inventory template.

2 Environment, security, and storage foundation

Indicative timing: Weeks 1-2

Primary objective: Provision AWS environments, configure the production deployment pattern, backups, monitoring, and implement the S3-based document storage approach required by the hosting model.

Key outputs: Configured lower environment, production-ready infrastructure pattern, access controls, backup and logging baseline, S3 document storage capability tested outside production.

3 Core legal operations configuration

Indicative timing: Weeks 2-3

Primary objective: Configure the operating heart of the platform around how the firm actually opens, runs, documents, and times work.

Key outputs: Matter structures, intake rules, calendar and deadline views, DMS conventions, templates, timekeeping flows, dashboard priorities, knowledge structures, and role-based navigation confirmed.

4 Finance, portal, and controlled support modules

Indicative timing: Weeks 3-4

Primary objective: Bring financial controls and client-service surfaces into the same implementation stream.

Key outputs: Rate cards, invoice workflows, expenses, trust accounting controls, client-portal access model, analytics baseline, internal helpdesk queue, and asset registry configuration.

5 Migration rehearsal, UAT, and training

Indicative timing: Weeks 4-5

Primary objective: Dry-run the migration, begin user testing and prepare end users before any production cutover.

Key outputs: Data-load rehearsal results, document-transfer rehearsal, signed UAT cases, reconciled finance test cases, lawyer training sessions, admin and support training sessions, go-live runbook.

6 Production cutover and Support

Indicative timing: Weeks 5-6 plus 2 weeks of support

Primary objective: Execute the final migration, switch users onto the new platform, and stabilise the operating model quickly with daily oversight.

Key outputs: Final cutover checklist, production go-live, active support desk, issue triage cadence, adoption tracking, and prioritised post-launch optimisation backlog.

RESPONSIBILITIES

Workstreams and responsibilities

WORKSTREAM	ELF DELIVERY RESPONSIBILITY	DM-INC RESPONSIBILITY	OUTPUT
Infrastructure and security	Implement AWS landing pattern, deployment, monitoring, backup, recovery, and storage architecture.	Approve hosting model, identity approach, security policies, and data-retention decisions.	Production-ready environment with agreed operational controls.
Application configuration	Configure modules, templates, rate structures, roles, workflows, and reporting views.	Provide process rules, exceptions, approval paths, and sample documents.	Firm-specific configuration aligned to actual working practice.
Data and document migration	Define mapping, dry-run loads, validation checks, and final cutover procedure.	Provide source extracts, field definitions, document sets, and sign-off on reconciliation.	Auditable migration path with lower go-live risk.
Training and adoption	Prepare role-based guides, deliver training, and run hypercare support rhythms.	Ensure attendance, nominate champions, and enforce the new operating standard internally.	Higher user adoption and fewer post-launch workarounds.

DM-Inc Commitments Required

- One **day-to-day project owner** who can coordinate legal, finance, and IT inputs.
- Named **workstream leads** for legal operations, finance, and infrastructure/security.
- **Availability of lawyers and support staff** for UAT, pilot feedback, and training attendance.
- **Timely sign-off** on migration rules, reporting requirements, and go-live acceptance criteria.

Data and document migration approach

- Start with an inventory of master data, live matters, closed matters, finance reference data, and the active document estate.
- Classify what must move for day-one operations versus what can be archived or migrated later.
- Map documents into the agreed S3-backed storage structure so the target operating model matches the hosting recommendation.
- Run at least one full rehearsal with record counts, sample document retrieval checks, and finance reconciliation checks before final cutover.

- Use final migration sign-off as a formal gate, not an informal assumption made at the end of the project.

Training and change management

- Train by role: lawyers, finance staff, administrators, support/operations, and champions.
- Use live client scenarios in training rather than generic product demonstrations.
- Issue short, focused guides for daily tasks: opening matters, capturing time, handling documents, billing, and portal communication.
- Nominate champion users in each practice group to absorb first-line questions during the first two weeks after launch.
- Track adoption during hypercare with a visible action list for fixes, clarifications, and process tuning.

Go-live criteria

Production go-live should only proceed once the core legal workflows, finance controls, document access, security model, and support model have all been proven in rehearsal and signed off.

Configuration sign-off: matters, calendar, DMS, timekeeping, and billing flows are approved by business owners.

Security sign-off: roles, access controls, backup policy, and operational support model are confirmed.

Migration sign-off: record counts, sample documents, and priority financial outputs reconcile successfully.

Training readiness: end-user guides are issued and pilot users have completed training.

Support readiness: hypercare team, escalation paths, and issue triage cadence are active from day one.

Prepared note

Prepared March 16, 2026. This implementation plan is aligned to the current DM-Inc ERP module scope and the AWS hosting model recommended in the companion hosting cost presentation. Any S3-backed document-storage outcome described here should be treated as a planned implementation deliverable before production go-live, not as an already-completed production-state capability.